

A SHARP FOCUS ON TALENT

The big boy in India's information technology industry focusses on keeping its employees happy and motivated

By **Krishna Gopalan**

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▶ **SEVERAL TIMES THROUGH** the conversation, Milind Lakkad speaks of how important it is to keep his staff happy. Just think about it. Tata Consultancy Services (TCS, as it is better known) is the big boy in India's IT industry with a workforce in excess of half a million spread across the globe. A lot of time goes into identifying the right talent and Lakkad knows his biggest asset is not the offices his company occupies or the number of clients they proudly serve—it comes to people and nothing more.

As Executive Vice President and CHRO of this behemoth of a company, standing still is a recipe for disaster. Two years of the pandemic has hit humankind and industry harder than anything ever. "We used that time well and really believe, that as an organisation today, the bonding in the team is very strong," he says. Take the case of the conventional way of training the staff. "Earlier, it was a schedule over three days in a classroom. Now, we use nano videos, quizzes or a case study," explains Lakkad. The advantage of this is quite simple—the company having upped the game on learning infrastructure sees intensity levels take off quite sharply. "We can do something like a sandbox and the new technology on cloud can be learnt sitting at home," says Lakkad. As a result of these measures, TCS is one of the top companies in the *BT-Taggd* Best Companies to Work For in India ranking this year.

The advantage of a pedigree like the Tatas means that getting the right talent is not very difficult. However, nothing is taken for granted and Lakkad outlines a few points to ensure that the sense of happiness is top priority. "Having a positive environment means you don't have to be pushed to get to work. Putting in place a culture of learning also means a person can quickly move up the value chain and has a more enriching career with us," he explains. Then there is the bit on the workforce needing to feel that they are being heard and valued.

PHOTOS BY **RACHIT GOSWAMI**



NURTURING EMPLOYEES Milind Lakkad, EVP & CHRO, TCS

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TATA CONSULTANCY SERVICES

Top attributes

- Clarity of company goals
- Growth and learning opportunities
- Job security and stability